Apex Systems

Proposal in response to RFP-2026-017: Enterprise Order-to-Cash Integration Platform
Submitted to: Meridian Foods Pvt Ltd (fictional)

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to RFP-2026-017: Enterprise Order-to-Cash Integration Platform issued by Meridian Foods Pvt Ltd (fictional). We understand that Meridian needs a single integration platform that connects its SAP S/4HANA ERP, the warehouse management system, the CRM and the government e-invoicing portal so that an order is captured, fulfilled, invoiced and reconciled without manual re-keying. Peak load is approximately 2,500 orders per hour during festival season, and finance requires a complete audit trail for every document.

Our proposal, ApexConnect, is an API-first integration platform built on a microservices architecture. It combines deep SAP expertise with an enterprise-grade security posture. We are not the cheapest option; we are offering the most technically robust and most secure solution, with a delivery schedule of nine months.

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Approach

Architecture: ApexConnect runs as containerised microservices on Kubernetes across three availability zones (multi-AZ), providing high availability with automatic failover and a 99.95% platform availability target. Services scale horizontally through auto-scaling policies driven by queue depth and CPU.

Integration: all systems exchange data through an event bus based on Apache Kafka, with REST APIs and webhooks exposed for the CRM and the e-invoicing portal. SAP connectivity uses certified BAPI and IDoc interfaces (SAP S/4HANA and ECC-compatible). We define a canonical data model for order, delivery and invoice, and we provide a field-level mapping workbook for every interface, signed off by Meridian before build.

Scalability evidence: in a recent load test, the platform sustained 6,000 transactions per hour with 400 concurrent API sessions and a median processing latency of 1.8 seconds. The test report will be shared during technical due diligence.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

The programme runs for nine months in four phases: Phase 1 Discovery and Design (6 weeks), Phase 2 Build (14 weeks), Phase 3 Integration Testing and UAT (10 weeks) and Phase 4 Go-live and Stabilisation (6 weeks). Milestones are M1 Design sign-off (week 6), M2 Build complete (week 20), M3 UAT sign-off (week 30) and M4 Go-live (week 36).

The core team comprises a project manager, a solution architect and eight engineers. Governance is through a fortnightly project review. The detailed resourcing plan and the formal risk register will be provided after contract award. Key risks we foresee are SAP interface change requests and data quality in legacy masters.

4. Price Table and Assumptions

Item	Description	3-year cost (INR lakh)
Platform licence (3 years)	ApexConnect core, Kafka, 5 environments	165.0
Implementation services	Design, build, testing, go-live	180.0
SAP and CRM connectors	BAPI/IDoc and REST connectors	45.0
Training and documentation	40 user-days, admin certification	12.0
Support (3 years)	Business-hours support, SLA 99.9%	78.0
Total	**Total contract price (3 years)**	**480.0**

Assumptions

- Fixed price for implementation; changes handled through the change request process at the agreed rate card.
- Payment terms: 20% on design sign-off, 30% on build complete, 30% on UAT sign-off, 20% on go-live.
- 24x7 Priority 1 coverage is optional and is quoted separately at INR 22 lakh over three years.
- Prices exclude GST and are valid for 90 days.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex Systems is certified to ISO/IEC 27001 and holds a SOC 2 Type II report covering the ApexConnect platform. An independent penetration test is performed every year and after every major release, with findings tracked under our vulnerability management process.

Data is encrypted with AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit. Access is controlled through role-based access control (RBAC) with least privilege, mandatory multi-factor authentication and SSO integration. Every transaction is written to an immutable audit trail that is streamed to a SIEM. Customer data is hosted in the India region to satisfy data residency, and our processes align with the DPDP Act. Disaster recovery targets are an RTO of 4 hours and an RPO of 15 minutes, tested twice a year. We operate a documented incident response plan with a 1-hour notification commitment.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Standard support is provided in business hours (09:00 to 18:00 IST, Monday to Friday) with a 99.9% service level (SLA) on production availability. 24x7 coverage for Priority 1 incidents is available as an optional add-on priced separately. Service credits apply for SLA breaches.

Apex has delivered three similar integration programmes for manufacturing and FMCG clients over the last five years. References: Ms. R. Kulkarni, CIO, Suryoday Beverages (fictional); Mr. A. Fernandes, Head of IT, Konkan Agro Foods (fictional).